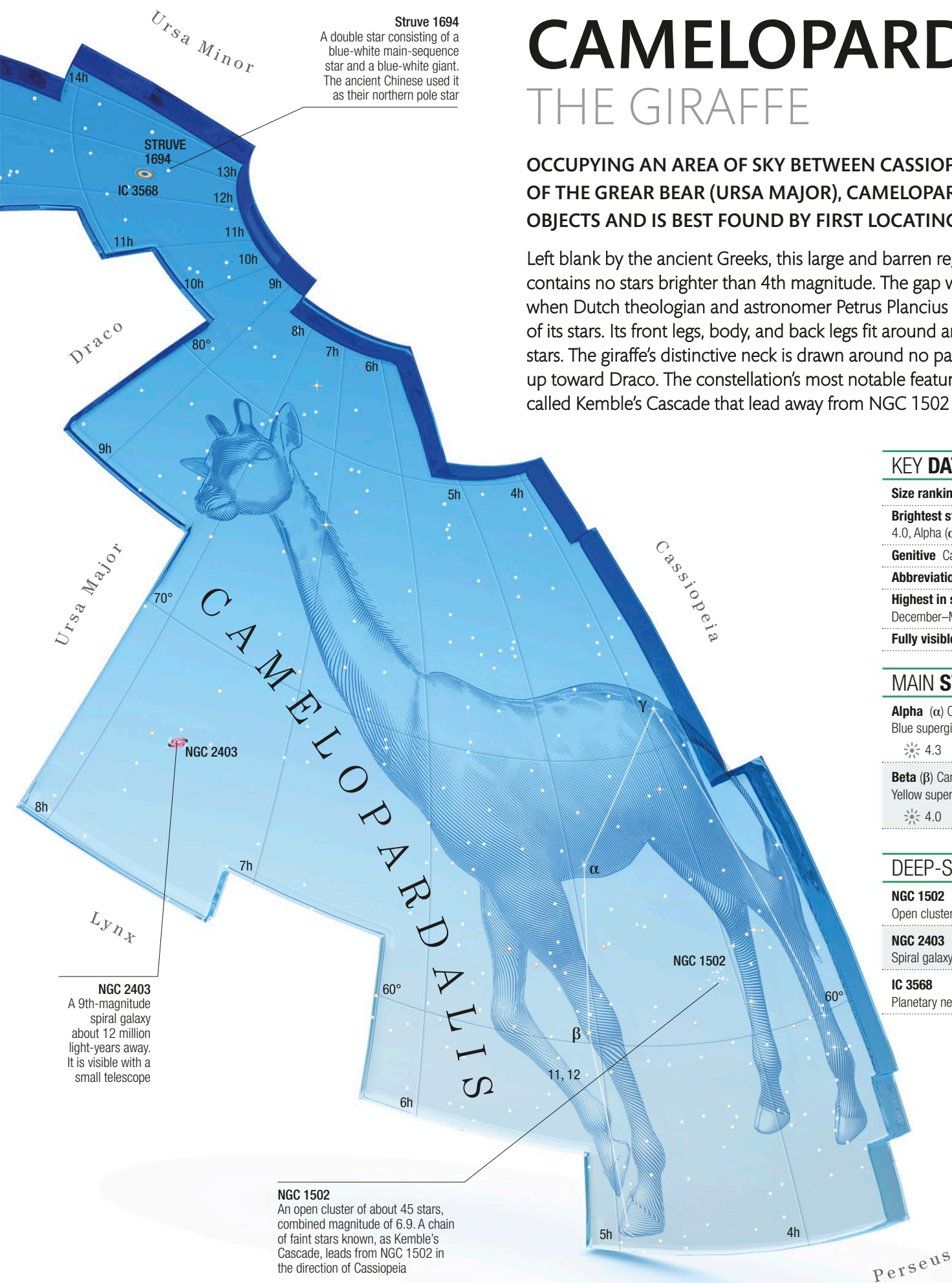




Struve 1694
A double star consisting of a blue-white main-sequence star and a blue-white giant. The ancient Chinese used it as their northern pole star

CAMELOPARDALIS

THE GIRAFFE

OCCUPYING AN AREA OF SKY BETWEEN CASSIOPEIA AND THE “HEAD” OF THE GREAR BEAR (URSA MAJOR), CAMELOPARDALIS LACKS BRIGHT OBJECTS AND IS BEST FOUND BY FIRST LOCATING ITS NEIGHBORS.

Left blank by the ancient Greeks, this large and barren region of northern sky contains no stars brighter than 4th magnitude. The gap was eventually filled in 1612 when Dutch theologian and astronomer Petrus Plancius drew a giraffe around some of its stars. Its front legs, body, and back legs fit around an inverted “U” shape of stars. The giraffe’s distinctive neck is drawn around no particular stars and stretches up toward Draco. The constellation’s most notable feature is a trail of unrelated stars called Kemble’s Cascade that lead away from NGC 1502 toward Cassiopeia.

KEY DATA

- Size ranking** 18
- Brightest stars** Beta (β) 4.0, Alpha (α) 4.3
- Genitive** Camelopardalis
- Abbreviation** Cam
- Highest in sky at 10pm** December–May
- Fully visible** 90°N–3°S



CHART 1

MAIN STARS

- Alpha (α) Camelopardalis**
Blue supergiant
4.3 6,269 light-years
- Beta (β) Camelopardalis**
Yellow supergiant and double star
4.0 872 light-years

DEEP-SKY OBJECTS

- NGC 1502**
Open cluster
- NGC 2403**
Spiral galaxy
- IC 3568**
Planetary nebula

NGC 2403
A 9th-magnitude spiral galaxy about 12 million light-years away. It is visible with a small telescope

NGC 1502
An open cluster of about 45 stars, combined magnitude of 6.9. A chain of faint stars known, as Kemble’s Cascade, leads from NGC 1502 in the direction of Cassiopeia